

THE DARK SIDE OF E-LEARNING

Not all is well in the digital land of e-learning. In this chapter we look at some of the major pitfalls.

Technology enhanced learning is a field where progress and penetration has always been slow in our country. While developed countries were quick to adapt to the changing ways in which education was being dispensed, India for the most part continued to rely on the traditional ways of teaching and learning. Online education or web-based learning to most of us is a recent phenomenon, to say the least. However, it has radically transformed the way people perceive knowledge and the way universities manage knowledge transfer. A middle-aged man is now able to learn programming fundamentals and interested youngsters can do a course on Spanish architecture without attending an elite arts institution.

No discussion about online learning can be complete without mentioning “MOOCs”, short for Massive Open Online Course, i.e. web-based classes designed to support a large number of participants. MOOC is a buzzword now, thanks to the phenomenal success of companies such as Coursera,